

WANG, Kangyu

kywang96@hku.hk | kangyu.wang@outlook.com | <https://kangyu-wang.github.io>

AOS: Decision Theory and Practical Reason, Philosophy of Artificial Intelligence/Machine Learning,
Philosophy of Economics and Finance, Moral and Political Philosophy,

AOC: Applied Ethics, Philosophy of Law, Chinese and Comparative Philosophy, Logic

Academic Appointment

Assistant Lecturer, *Department of Philosophy, The University of Hong Kong*, Hong Kong, 9/2025-

Programme Development and Coordination, *Bachelor of Arts and Bachelor of Engineering
(Artificial Intelligence and Data Science)*, HKU

Research Affiliate, *The AI & Humanity Lab*, HKU

Resident Fellow (Inaugural Cohort), *Hong Kong Global AI Governance Hub*, HKU

Education

PhD in Philosophy, *London School of Economics*, 9/2021-5/2026

Supervisors: Dr Campbell Brown (primary), Dr Kieran Oberman (secondary)

Former supervisor: Prof Johanna Thoma (LSE till 2/2023; Bayreuth since 3/2023)

Thesis: *Hard Choices and Human Agency*

Studentship (Open Competition), *The London Arts & Humanities Partnership*

Visiting PhD Student, *Rutgers University-New Brunswick*, 1/2024-5/2024

Sponsor: Prof Michael Otsuka

Visiting PhD Student, *University of Toronto*, 9/2023-12/2023

Sponsor: Prof Sergio Tenenbaum

Visiting PhD Student, *Australian National University*, 7/2023-9/2023

Sponsor: Prof Katie Steele

MSc Philosophy & Public Policy, *London School of Economics*, 9/2019-9/2020

With Double-Distinction; Dissertation Supervisor: Prof Alex Voorhoeve

LL.B. Philosophy, Politics & Economics, *Renmin University of China*, 9/2015-6/2019

Scholarship of Philosophy (Best Thesis of the Year; Supervisor: Prof ZHOU Lian)

National Scholarship, *Ministry of Education of China*, 2018

Visiting Student, *University College Dublin*, 9/2017-12/2017

Publication

Top Peer-Reviewed Computer Science Venues

‘AI Agents and Hard Choices’, *The 2026 ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency (ACM FAccT 2026)*, non-archival.

Journal Article

A paper on risk appetite, investment, and distributive justice, R&R, *Economics & Philosophy*

Book Review

‘Value Incommensurability: Ethics, Risk, and Decision-Making, Henrik Andersson and Anders Herlitz (ed.). Routledge, 2022, viii 269 pages.’ *Economics & Philosophy*, 2024; 40(3): 749-755 (with Campbell Brown).

Departmental Blog

‘How AI Challenges Prudential Regulation’, LSE Philosophy Blog, 5/8/2024

Public Engagement

‘EP. 157: Artificial Intelligence and Prudential Supervision,’ *Toronto Centre Podcasts* by Toronto Centre, with Manoj Singh (Deputy General Manager, Reserve Bank of India)

Awards

‘When not to pick’, *The 2025 Jacobsen Essay Prize*, The Jacobsen Committee and the Directors of Graduate Studies of the University of London Constituent Colleges

Philosophy Presentations

Peer-Reviewed

‘The Hierarchy of Liquidity’, *The PPE Society London Meeting*, King’s College London, 10/7/2026

‘Making hard choices for changing selves’, *The 100th Joint Session of the Aristotelian Society and the Mind Association*, Reading, England, 9/7/2026

‘AI Agents and Hard Choices’, *APA Pacific 2026*, online, 12/4/2026

‘On what makes money money’, *The Zicklin Center Workshop in Normative Business Ethics 2025-2026*, The Wharton School, University of Pennsylvania, 20/3/2026

‘Private bank monies are good’, *Society for Business Ethics Annual Meeting “Emerging Scholars Workshop & Networking Event”*, 26/7/2025, Copenhagen Business School, Copenhagen

- ‘Private bank monies are good’, *PPE Society London: 1st Annual Meeting*, 18/7/2025, King’s College London (“Banking” panel leading co-proposer together with Violet Victoria and Valerie Schreur)
- ‘Private bank monies are good’, *2025 Association for Social and Political Philosophy Annual Conference*, 15/7/2025, University of Glasgow (“Philosophy of Banking” panel leading co-proposer together with Violet Victoria and Valerie Schreur, discussant Lisa Herzog)
- ‘When not to pick’, *99th Joint Session of the Aristotelian Society and the Mind Association*, University of Glasgow, 13/7/2025
- ‘Private bank monies are good’, *2025 Warwick Graduate Conference in Political & Legal Theory*, 22/2/2025, University of Warwick
- ‘When not to pick casually?’, *PPE Society 8th Annual Meeting*, New Orleans, 16/11/2024
- ‘Asset allocation, capital allocation, and two moral deficits of modern finance’ (co-authored with Paul Forrester), *PPE Society 8th Annual Meeting*, New Orleans, 16/11/2024
- ‘Investment returns, risk appetites, luck egalitarianism, and sovereign wealth funds’ (co-authored with Paul Forrester), *Workshop on Advancing the Understanding of Everyday Financial Risk*, Goldsmiths, University of London, 7-8/11/2024
- ‘How AI Challenges Prudential Regulation’, *3rd International Conference on the Ethics of Artificial Intelligence*, University of the Azores, Ponta Delgada, Portugal, 19/9/2024
- ‘When to flip a coin?’, *Salzburg Conference for Young Analytic Philosophy: SOPhiA 2024*, University of Salzburg, Austria, 13/9/2024
- ‘When to flip a coin?’, *Understanding Value XII*, University of Sheffield, England, 16/7/2024
- ‘Investment Returns, Luck Egalitarianism, and Sovereign Funds’ (co-authored with Paul Forrester), *The 28th MANCEPT Brave New World Conference*, University of Manchester, England, 11/7/2024
- ‘Everything everywhen all at once’, *The 19th London-Berkeley Graduate Philosophy Conference*, London, 16/5/2024
- ‘Everything everywhen all at once’, *The American Philosophical Association 2024 Pacific Division Meeting*, Portland, Oregon, 20/3/2024
- ‘Uncertainty, Unawareness and why now is not the time to prioritise AI existential risk’ (poster), *The 5th Conference on “Philosophy of Artificial Intelligence”*, Friedrich-Alexander-Universität Erlangen-Nürnberg, Germany, 15/12/2023
- ‘Freedom and dynamic decision-making’, *MANCEPT Workshop in Political Theory*, University of Manchester, England, 11/9/2023
- ‘Sophisticated Sophistication Strategy in Dynamic Decision Making’, *Issues in Dynamic Decision Theory*, University of Konstanz, Germany, 7/7/2023
- ‘What makes life meaningful? A novel subjectivist theory’, *Fifth International Conference on Philosophy and Meaning in Life*, Tohoku University, Japan, 30/6/2023

‘What is the point of relational equality?’, *4th POLEMO Symposium*, Central European University, Vienna, Austria, 2/6/2023

‘What is the point of relational equality?’, *USC-UCLA Graduate Philosophy Conference*, The University of Southern California, Los Angeles, 15/4/2023

‘What makes life meaningful? A novel subjectivist theory’, *Understanding Value XI*, The University of Sheffield, England, 22/3/2023

‘What makes life meaningful?’, *2023 Beijing International Graduate Conference in Analytic Philosophy*, Beijing Normal University, China, 7/1/2023

‘The Freedom of Odysseus’, *London Graduate Philosophy Conference*, University of London, England, 26/11/2021

Invited

‘Do Language Models Dream of Human Societies?’ (coauthored with Chong Liu), *The 4th Philosophy and Artificial Intelligence Conference (PhAI-4)*, Veritas Research Center, Underwood International College, Yonsei University, Seoul, 16/5/2026

‘Rational AI and Causal AI’, AI Governance Institute, Renmin University of China, 28/4/2026

‘AI Agents and Hard Choices’, *Center for Philosophy & the Future of Humanity and Department of Philosophy*, Peking University, 27/4/2026

‘AI Disinformation and the Combatant/Non-Combatant Distinction’ (coauthored with Sean Donahue), *AI and the Future of Platform Workshop*, The University of Hong Kong, 1/4/2026

‘Simulating Society with Generative AI: The Limits of LLM-ABM in Social Science’ (coauthored with Chong Liu), *Underwood International College, Yonsei University*, Seoul, 30/3/2026

‘Causal Decision Theory and Causal World Models’, *Yat-sen Logic Symposium*, Sun Yat-sen University, Guangzhou, 18/3/2026

‘Can machine learning agents handle hard choices?’, *Responsible AI in Action Workshop*, The Chinese University of Hong Kong, 2/12/2025

‘Can machine learning agents handle hard choices?’, *Logical Analysis and Critical Philosophy Lecture Series*, Zhejiang University, 13/10/2025

‘Can machine learning agents handle hard choices?’, *Google DeepMind London Office*, 27/5/2025

‘Can machine learning agents handle hard choices?’, *The Machine Intelligence and Normative Theory Lab*, Australian National University, 17/4/2025

‘Investment returns, risk appetites, luck egalitarianism, and the put seller of the last resort’ (coauthored with Paul Forrester), *LSE Choice Group*, England, 9/10/2024

‘How AI Challenges Prudential Regulation’, *The Machine Intelligence and Normative Theory Lab*, Australian National University, 15/8/24

‘When to flip a coin? An internalist approach to hard choices’, *Value Theory Discussion Group*, Rutgers-New Brunswick, New Jersey, 5/4/2024

- ‘In the long run we are all dumb’, *The Center for Population-Level Bioethics Seminars*, Rutgers-New Brunswick, New Jersey, 25/3/2024
- ‘In the long run we are all dumb: uncertainty, unawareness, and a case for neartermism’, *The 13th Oxford Workshop on Global Priorities Research*, Oxford, 4/12/2023
- ‘Freedom and dynamic decision-making’, *Centre for Moral, Social and Political Theory Work-in-Progress Group*, Australian National University, ACT Australia, 1/9/2023
- ‘A sentimentalist theory of hard choice’, *Philosophy of Mind Group*, Australian National University, Canberra, 30/8/2023
- ‘What makes life meaningful?’, *LSE Choice Group*, England, 9/11/2022
- ‘The Freedom of Odysseus’, *Erasmus School of Philosophy PhD Student Conference*, Erasmus University Rotterdam, 17/10/2022
- ‘The Freedom of Odysseus’, *South, West & Wales Doctoral Training Partnership (UKRI-AHRC) Summer Research Festival 2022 (SWWDTP2)*, University of Exeter, England, 28/9/2022
- ‘What is the point of relational egalitarianism?’, *The 5th London Graduate Workshop in Moral and Political Philosophy*, University of London, England, 22/4/2022

Teaching

Early-Career Teaching

AIHU1001 Foundations of AI and Humanity, The University of Hong Kong, since 9/2025

Postgraduate Teaching

Ethics of Data and AI, LSE Summer School, 6/2025-7/2025

Teacher Responsible: Dr Kate Vredenburg

Anarchy, Authority and Evidence: Topics in Philosophy of Law, LSE, 2024-2025

Teacher Responsible: Dr Lewis Ross

Other Teacher: Dr Jonathan Parry

Philosophy, Morals and Politics, LSE, 2022-2023

Teacher Responsible: Dr Lewis Ross

Other Teachers: Dr Kieran Oberman, Dr Nikhil Venkatesh, Dr Daniel Guillery

Academic Services & Other Affiliation

Research Affiliate, The Machine Intelligence and Normative Theory Lab (MINT Lab, PI: Prof Seth Lazar), since 11/2023

Program Committee, AAAI/ACM AIES’26

Reviewer, NeurIPS’26 Position Paper Track

Reviewer, ACM FAccT'26

Reviewer, AAAI/ACM AIES'25

Reviewer, *Philosophy, Politics & Economics*, since 10/2024

Reviewer, *Synthese*, since 6/2023

Key organiser and Chair, *The LSE Choice Group*, LSE Philosophy, 2021-2024

Key organiser and Chair, *The 5th London Graduate Workshop in Moral and Political Philosophy*,
University of London, England, 2022

References

PhD Supervisors

Dr Campbell Brown, Associate Professor, London School of Economics, C.F.Brown@lse.ac.uk

Dr Kieran Oberman, Associate Professor, London School of Economics, K.Oberman@lse.ac.uk

External referees

Prof Michael Otsuka, Rutgers University-New Brunswick, michael.otsuka@rutgers.edu

Prof Sergio Tenenbaum, University of Toronto, sergio.tenenbaum@utoronto.ca

Prof Johanna Thoma, University of Bayreuth, johanna.thoma@uni-bayreuth.de

Teaching

Dr Lewis Ross, Assistant Professor, London School of Economics, L.Ross2@lse.ac.uk

Dr Kieran Oberman, Associate Professor, London School of Economics, K.Oberman@lse.ac.uk

For academic reference letters, please contact Dr Campbell Brown, Prof Michael Otsuka, and Prof Sergio Tenenbaum; for teaching reference letter, please contact Dr Lewis Ross.